

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 948

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to recognize and celebrate the twentieth anniversary of the Tennessee Agricultural Enhancement Program (TAEP) and to honor its enduring contributions to Tennessee agriculture.

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Agricultural Enhancement Program (TAEP) was established in 2005 by the Tennessee General Assembly and is administered by the Tennessee Department of Agriculture to strengthen farm operations and promote long-term agricultural sustainability across the State; and

WHEREAS, originally created during a period of transition in Tennessee agriculture following the conclusion of the federal tobacco program, TAEP was designed to provide strategic cost-share assistance that would help producers adapt, diversify, and invest confidently in their operations; and

WHEREAS, over the past twenty years, TAEP has grown far beyond its initial purpose and has become a cornerstone program for Tennessee's agricultural community, widely recognized and relied upon by farm families in every region of the State; and

WHEREAS, the program reimburses approved applicants for eligible expenses at a fifty percent cost-share rate, subject to program-specific maximums, encouraging a strong financial partnership between the State of Tennessee and agricultural producers, while enabling producers to make meaningful capital improvements; and

WHEREAS, TAEP encompasses a broad array of program areas, including dairy solutions, genetics, hay storage, hay equipment, herd health, livestock equipment, livestock solutions, poultry grower, row crop solutions, swine producer, working structures and fence-line systems, and producer diversification, supporting agritourism, fruits and vegetables, honey bees, horticulture, organic production, and value-added enterprises; and

WHEREAS, through its annual application process and continuous refinement, TAEP has supported more than 97,000 agricultural projects and invested more than \$309 million in cost-share funding since its inception, generating an estimated economic impact of more than \$2 billion for Tennessee's rural communities; and

WHEREAS, under the leadership of Commissioner Andy Holt and the dedicated professionals of the Tennessee Department of Agriculture, the program continues to demonstrate the State's unwavering commitment to agricultural advancement, rural prosperity, and the preservation of Tennessee's farming heritage; and

WHEREAS, as TAEP celebrated its twentieth year in 2025, it stands as a testament to thoughtful public policy, strong producer participation, and the enduring strength and resilience of Tennessee agriculture; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Tennessee Agricultural Enhancement Program upon the occasion of its twentieth anniversary and express our gratitude for its lasting impact on the agricultural economy and farm families of this great State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.